

MTH 202 Chapter 1: Three-Dimensional Space & Vectors

1.3 Worksheet

1. Which of the following expressions are defined? Which are meaningless? Explain.

a) $(\mathbf{a} \cdot \mathbf{b}) \cdot \mathbf{c}$

b) $(\mathbf{a} \cdot \mathbf{b})\mathbf{c}$

c) $\|\mathbf{a}\|(\mathbf{b} \cdot \mathbf{c})$

d) $\mathbf{a} \cdot (\mathbf{b} + \mathbf{c})$

e) $\mathbf{a} \cdot \mathbf{b} + \mathbf{c}$

f) $\|\mathbf{a}\| \cdot (\mathbf{b} + \mathbf{c})$

2. Find $\mathbf{a} \cdot \mathbf{b}$ for each of the following sets of vectors and determine the angle between each of these vectors. Round angles to 2 decimal places and express these angles in radians.

a) $\mathbf{a} = \langle -2, 3 \rangle$ & $\mathbf{b} = \langle 0.7, 1.2 \rangle$

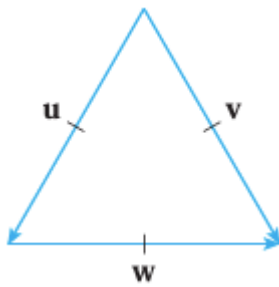
b) $\mathbf{a} = \langle 6, -2, 3 \rangle$ & $\mathbf{b} = \langle 2, 5, -1 \rangle$

c) $\mathbf{a} = 2\mathbf{i} + \mathbf{j}$ & $\mathbf{b} = \mathbf{i} - \mathbf{j} + \mathbf{k}$

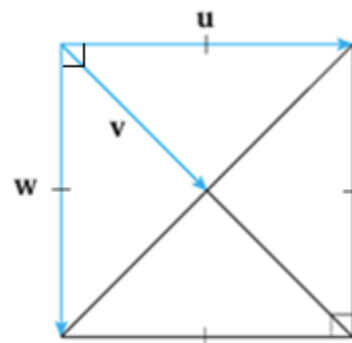
d) $\mathbf{a} = 4\mathbf{i} - 3\mathbf{j} + \mathbf{k}$ & $\mathbf{b} = 2\mathbf{i} - \mathbf{k}$

3. If $\mathbf{u}$ is a unit vector, find $\mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{v}$ and $\mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{w}$.

a)



b)



4. Determine the angle between the vector $\mathbf{u} = \langle 1, 2, 3 \rangle$ and each of the coordinate axes. Round angles to 2 decimal places and express these angles in radians.

5. Determine if the given vectors are orthogonal, parallel, or neither.

a) $\mathbf{a} = \langle -5, 3, 7 \rangle$ & $\mathbf{b} = \langle 6, -8, 2 \rangle$

b) $\mathbf{a} = \langle 4, 6 \rangle$ & $\mathbf{b} = \langle -3, 2 \rangle$

c) $\mathbf{a} = -\mathbf{i} + 2\mathbf{j} + 5\mathbf{k}$ & $\mathbf{b} = 3\mathbf{i} + 4\mathbf{j} - \mathbf{k}$

d) $\mathbf{a} = 2\mathbf{i} + 6\mathbf{j} - 4\mathbf{k}$ & $\mathbf{b} = -3\mathbf{i} - 9\mathbf{j} + 6\mathbf{k}$

6. Find the component and projection of $\mathbf{b}$ onto $\mathbf{a}$. In the 2-dimensional cases include a sketch of these vectors and the projection (sketch all vectors starting from the origin).

a) $\mathbf{a} = \langle -5, 12 \rangle$ & $\mathbf{b} = \langle 4, 6 \rangle$

b) $\mathbf{a} = \langle 1, 4 \rangle$ & $\mathbf{b} = \langle 2, 3 \rangle$

c) $\mathbf{a} = \langle -2, 3, -6 \rangle$ & $\mathbf{b} = \langle 5, -1, 4 \rangle$

d) $\mathbf{a} = 2\mathbf{i} - \mathbf{j} + 4\mathbf{k}$ & $\mathbf{b} = \mathbf{j} + \frac{1}{2}\mathbf{k}$

7. Suppose that $\mathbf{a}$ and $\mathbf{b}$ are nonzero vectors.

a) Under what circumstances is $\text{comp}_{\mathbf{a}}(\mathbf{b}) = \text{comp}_{\mathbf{b}}(\mathbf{a})$.

b) Under what circumstances is $\text{proj}_{\mathbf{a}}(\mathbf{b}) = \text{proj}_{\mathbf{b}}(\mathbf{a})$.

8. If $\mathbf{c} = \|\mathbf{a}\|\mathbf{b} + \|\mathbf{b}\|\mathbf{a}$, where $\mathbf{a}$, $\mathbf{b}$, and $\mathbf{c}$ are all nonzero vectors, show that $\mathbf{c}$ bisects the angle between $\mathbf{a}$ and $\mathbf{b}$.

9. Show that if $\mathbf{u} + \mathbf{v}$ and $\mathbf{u} - \mathbf{v}$ are orthogonal, then the vectors $\mathbf{u}$ and $\mathbf{v}$ must have the same length.

10. If $\mathbf{r} = \langle x, y, z \rangle$, $\mathbf{a} = \langle a_1, a_2, a_3 \rangle$, & $\mathbf{b} = \langle b_1, b_2, b_3 \rangle$, show that the vector equation $(\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{a}) \cdot (\mathbf{r} - \mathbf{b}) = 0$ represents a sphere, and find its center and radius.